

07 - Dragon Bestiary (Part II)

Project: Dragon Merchant Guild (*Working Title*)

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Species 004 — Mosshorn Drake

Scientific Name

Sylvadraco muscicornis

Ecological Class

Forest Dweller

Guild Profession(s)

- Forestry
 - Agriculture
 - Reforestation
 - Herbal Gathering
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Habitat

Ancient forests, overgrown valleys, moss-covered cliffs, and humid woodlands.

Diet

Moss, ferns, berries, mushrooms, bark, medicinal herbs, and flowering shrubs.

Temperament

Gentle.

Observant.

Patient.

Highly territorial toward damaged forests but rarely aggressive toward people.

Primary Instinct

Mosshorns instinctively cultivate healthy forests.

As they travel, spores and seeds cling to the moss growing across their horns and scales. Over time they unknowingly spread vegetation across damaged woodland.

They are not planting forests intentionally.

They simply carry the forest with them.

Guild Discovery

Lumber guilds noticed that abandoned logging sites visited by Mosshorns recovered far faster than untouched areas.

Modern forestry guilds often send Mosshorns into harvested regions before planting new saplings.

Guild Applications

- Reforestation
 - Seed dispersal
 - Medicinal herb discovery
 - Sustainable logging
 - Forest surveys
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Strengths

- Excellent memory of forest trails.
- Naturally encourages plant growth.

- Rarely startles wildlife.
 - Finds medicinal plants with remarkable consistency.
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Weaknesses

- Stressed by barren environments.
 - Performs poorly in cities.
 - Avoids open grasslands.
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Care Difficulty

Moderate.

Mosshorns require access to living vegetation and benefit greatly from quiet environments.

Daily Routine

Morning begins with slow wandering through woodland paths.

Afternoons are often spent grazing and spreading spores before resting beneath large trees during the evening.

Interesting Behaviors

Small birds frequently build temporary nests upon older Mosshorns.

The dragons appear completely unbothered.

Relationship with Humans

They trust calm workers who respect the forest.

Aggressive logging quickly destroys that trust.

Relationship with Other Dragons

Mosshorns often coexist peacefully with Riverveil Drakes.

Together they naturally maintain healthy riverbanks.

Merchant Value

High.

Healthy forests provide lumber, medicine, wildlife, and long-term sustainability.

Species Story

Legends claim the oldest forests remember every Mosshorn that has ever walked beneath their branches.

Whether truth or folklore, many foresters tell stories of forgotten woodland paths mysteriously reopening after a lone Mosshorn passed through the area. New flowers bloom where its footsteps once rested, and fallen trees gradually become homes for fresh life.

Perhaps the dragon is simply carrying seeds.

Or perhaps the forest itself quietly follows its oldest gardener.

Guildmaster's Observation

"Never measure a Mosshorn's work by today's harvest. Measure it by what the forest becomes ten years from now."

Evolution of Implementation

Early

- Forest region

Intermediate

- Tree regeneration

Collections

- Plant database

LINQ

- Search medicinal herbs

Advanced

- Dynamic ecosystems
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Future Expansion

- Seasonal forests
 - Wildlife interactions
 - Rare herbs
 - Forest spirits (rumors only)
 - Biodiversity mechanics
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Species 005 — Longtail Courier

Scientific Name

Aerodraco longicauda

Ecological Class

Grassland Dragon

Guild Profession(s)

- Courier
 - Messenger
 - Light Transport
 - Exploration
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Habitat

Rolling plains, open grasslands, coastal cliffs, and wide valleys.

Diet

Small game, insects, berries, and prairie grasses.

Temperament

Energetic.

Friendly.

Curious.

Impatient.

Primary Instinct

Longtail Couriers naturally roam enormous territories.

Unlike territorial dragons, they constantly patrol long distances in search of changing weather, migrating prey, and safe nesting grounds.

Guilds eventually realized these dragons could memorize trade routes with astonishing accuracy.

Guild Discovery

Merchants observed that Longtails routinely traveled between distant settlements following nearly identical paths every season.

Eventually they began attaching lightweight satchels to cooperative dragons.

The first courier network was born.

Guild Applications

- Mail delivery
 - Trade communication
 - Small cargo
 - Emergency dispatches
 - Route scouting
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Strengths

- Extremely fast.
 - Exceptional memory.
 - Easily trained.
 - Excellent endurance.
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Weaknesses

- Cannot carry heavy loads.
 - Becomes restless if confined.
 - Easily distracted by changing weather.
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Care Difficulty

Low.

Longtails simply require room to run and frequent opportunities to travel.

Daily Routine

Morning patrols.

Long-distance courier routes.

Evening rest before beginning another journey at sunrise.

Interesting Behaviors

Every Longtail chooses one favorite resting location somewhere along its route.

Even after years away, it almost always returns there.

Relationship with Humans

Forms friendships quickly.

Often greets familiar workers before accepting deliveries.

Relationship with Other Dragons

Gets along well with nearly every species due to its naturally social disposition.

Merchant Value

Extremely High.

Fast communication transformed trade more than almost any other domesticated dragon.

Species Story

Before courier dragons existed, merchants often waited weeks for news from neighboring cities.

Then came the Longtails.

No one remembers who first trusted a dragon with an important letter, only that the dragon returned carrying another.

Within a generation, trade routes became lifelines connecting distant communities, and many historians argue that merchant guilds owe their existence as much to Longtail Couriers as they do to gold itself.

Guildmaster's Observation

"Feed them before asking them to travel. Hungry Longtails have an unfortunate habit of accepting 'shortcuts' only they understand."

Evolution of Implementation

- Route system
 - Mail mechanics
 - Travel time
 - Async deliveries
 - World map expansion
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Future Expansion

- Weather

- Reputation delivery
 - Courier events
 - Trade caravans
 - Regional economies
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Foundational Ecosystem

The first five documented species represent the earliest partnerships between dragons and merchant guilds.

Together they support nearly every basic operation required for a successful settlement.

Species	Natural Role	Guild Contribution
Stonejaw Drake	Shapes mountains	Mining & Construction
Hearthscale Drake	Maintains warm nests	Smithing & Hospitality
Riverveil Drake	Protects waterways	Fishing & Water Management
Mosshorn Drake	Restores forests	Forestry & Agriculture
Longtail Courier	Roams vast territories	Communication & Transport

Notice that no species exists solely to perform a job.

Each dragon evolved long before merchant guilds existed.

Guilds merely learned how to cooperate with instincts that nature had already perfected.

Closing Thoughts

This Bestiary is not a complete record of dragonkind.

It is merely the beginning.

Countless species remain undocumented beyond distant mountains, forgotten islands, dense jungles, frozen tundras, and unexplored caverns.

Some may become trusted companions.

Others may refuse human contact entirely.

Some may challenge everything scholars currently believe about dragons.

That uncertainty is intentional.

Discovery has always been one of the greatest rewards of exploration.

The Dragon Merchant Guild exists not to conquer nature, but to understand it.

And perhaps that is the greatest lesson every apprentice guildmaster must eventually learn.

Guiding Principle

A guild does not create great dragons.

Great dragons shape great guilds.

May every new species added to this Bestiary honor that philosophy while adding another page to the ever-growing story of dragons and those fortunate enough to walk beside them.